

Tab 1

# THE HEALING AND GROWTH JOURNAL

## *Website Design & Development Brief*

Prepared for: Website Designer / Developer

Purpose: A complete build guide for the official digital home of The Healing and Growth Journal.

Core positioning: The website should be the digital home of The Healing and Growth Journal, with Substack serving as the publishing, newsletter, and subscriber engine.

## 1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

The Healing and Growth Journal is a platform dedicated to healing, self-discovery, personal growth, grief support, reflection, emotional wellness, resilience, and becoming the best version of yourself.

The website must feel like a warm, human, thoughtful and trustworthy space—not a generic blog, therapy template, magazine template, or corporate wellness website.

The primary goals are:

1. · Create a strong, searchable home for the brand that can be discovered through Google and other search engines.
2. · Build an owned digital home for the brand rather than making Substack the only home.
3. · Connect readers naturally to the Substack publication and subscription page.
4. · Publish selected evergreen articles and resources on the website.
5. · Create a professional shop for digital products such as journals, journal prompts, guides and future resources.
6. · Give new visitors an easy path to understand the brand, find the right content, subscribe, and eventually purchase resources.
7. · Create a scalable structure that can later support courses, books, professional support, community offerings and other future developments.

## 2. BRAND FOUNDATION — USE THIS LANGUAGE CAREFULLY

Brand Name: The Healing and Growth Journal

Primary tagline: A place to heal, love, and grow.

Brand purpose: A platform dedicated to healing, self-discovery, personal growth, grief support, reflection, emotional wellness, resilience, and becoming the best version of yourself.

Vision: To help people navigate difficult seasons in life without losing themselves.

honest and vulnerable; hopeful without being preachy; deep but easy to understand; like a real person writing from lived experience.

Writing style: Reflective and thoughtful; conversational rather than academic; emotionally intelligent; gentle but powerful; able to move between deep reflection, practical guidance, clear explanations, personal observations, life lessons, poetry, short-form writing and long-form articles.

Important: Do not replace the brand language with generic wellness, motivational, therapy, or self-help language. The site should sound like The Healing and Growth Journal.

### 3. VISUAL DIRECTION

The visual identity should use the existing brand direction: gradient cream, light green and cream, with orange as an accent. The overall appearance should be soft, warm, human and calm.

- Use generous white/cream space and breathing room.
- Use subtle light-green and cream sections with restrained orange accents.
- Typography should feel editorial, elegant and highly readable.
- Use rounded or softly structured elements where appropriate, but avoid an overly playful look.
- Do not make the website look like a generic Substack clone.
- Do not overload pages with graphics, animations or decorative elements.
- The site should feel human-made, intimate and premium without looking expensive or corporate

### 4. REQUIRED MAIN NAVIGATION

- Home
- About
- Start Here
- The Journal / Articles
- Resources
- Shop
- Substack / Subscribe
- Contact

The navigation should remain simple and visible. On mobile, use a clean mobile menu. The Subscribe/Join the Journal action should be visually prominent without becoming aggressive.

# 5. HOME PAGE — REQUIRED STRUCTURE

## 5.1 Hero Section

Headline should clearly communicate what the Journal is. Recommended direction: “A place to heal, love, and grow.”

Supporting copy should briefly explain that The Healing and Growth Journal offers reflections, stories, healing notes and resources for people moving through grief, heartbreak, difficult seasons, life transitions and personal growth.

Primary CTA: “Start Here”

Secondary CTA: “Read the Journal”

A visible Substack subscription CTA should also appear within the home page journey.

## 5.2 What We Write About

Create four visually distinct content areas:

- Healing — Grief, loss, emotional healing, letting go, disappointment.
- Growth — Self-discovery, confidence, identity, purpose, becoming.
- Relationships — Love, heartbreak, friendship, boundaries, connection.
- Reflection — Personal essays, letters, journal entries, quiet observations about life.

## 5.3 Featured / Latest Writing

Show selected recent articles with large, emotionally relevant images, title, short excerpt and a clear Read button.

## 5.4 Start Here

This section should help a first-time visitor immediately identify where to begin.

- If you are grieving → start with selected grief and loss pieces.
- If you are healing from heartbreak → start with selected relationship and healing pieces.
- If you are starting again → start with growth and transition pieces.
- If you feel lost → start with self-discovery and reflection pieces.
- If you want to understand yourself better → explore the self-awareness resources.

## 5.5 Substack Invitation

Explain that readers can subscribe to The Healing and Growth Journal on Substack for regular reflections, healing notes, love letters, poems and growth resources.

Primary CTA: “Subscribe on Substack”

## **5.6 Resources / Shop Preview**

Show a small number of featured resources/products and link to the full Shop.

## **5.7 Closing Brand Section**

Use a quiet, emotionally resonant closing invitation rather than a loud sales banner. The feeling should be: you do not have to figure everything out alone.

# **6. ABOUT PAGE**

The About page must preserve the founder's personal story and should not be rewritten into generic corporate copy. The story centers on the loss of her father on 19 March 2025, two days before her convocation, and how grief changed her unexpectedly.

Core ideas to preserve:

- “Healing is not always about moving on. Sometimes, it is about learning how to carry what changed you.”
- “I don't write because I have everything figured out. I write because I am learning too.”
- The work grew from sitting with others in their pain—their tears, fears and questions.
- The Journal exists to help people find strength in difficult seasons, courage when uncertain, and hope when the road ahead is unclear.
- The brand believes healing is possible and that memories can be cherished.

Include a professional founder profile/photo area, a short description of the founder, and a clear connection between her experience, her writing and the Journal's purpose.

The page should also communicate professional guidance and a compassionate community without making the website look like a clinical medical practice.

# **7. START HERE PAGE**

This should function as the orientation page for first-time visitors.

- Start here if you are grieving.
- Start here if you are healing from heartbreak.
- Start here if you are going through a difficult season.
- Start here if you are starting over.

- Start here if you feel lost or disconnected from yourself.
- Start here if you want to grow intentionally.

Each pathway should contain 3–5 carefully selected articles/resources and a short explanation of why they are relevant.

## 8. THE JOURNAL / ARTICLES

The website should have a searchable, filterable article library.

Suggested categories/tags:

- Healing
- Grief & Loss
- Emotional Healing
- Letting Go
- Growth
- Becoming
- Love
- Heartbreak
- Boundaries
- Connection
- Reflection
- Personal Essays
- Letters
- Journal Entries

Article pages should include: title, featured image, category/tag, publication date, readable body typography, related articles, Substack CTA, and optional resource/product CTA.

The website should support SEO metadata, clean URLs, social sharing, image alt text, canonical URLs where appropriate, XML sitemap, robots.txt, and Google Search Console integration.

## 9. SUNDAY LOVE SERIES

The Sunday publishing tradition should be represented as a recognizable recurring series. Use the name “The Sunday Love Series” consistently wherever relevant.

It may contain love articles, poems and letters. The visual treatment should be recognizable but still part of the overall brand.

## 10.1 Featured resource ideas

- 31-Day Gentle Healing Journal — A gentle journey for anyone learning to live with what happened and still move forward.
- Journal Prompts for Difficult Seasons — Guided prompts for readers who need language for what they are carrying.
- Healing After Heartbreak Guide — Practical and reflective support for navigating the aftermath of heartbreak.
- The Starting Again Guide — A resource for people rebuilding after change, disappointment or a difficult season.
- Self-Discovery Journal — Prompts designed to help readers understand themselves more deeply.
- Reflection Workbook — Space to pause, process, learn and move forward.

## 11. JOURNAL PROMPT / SEO CONTENT LIBRARY

The website should contain individual evergreen pages built around specific questions readers are likely to search. These should not be generic keyword pages. Each page should answer a real emotional question with useful, compassionate writing and then point readers toward relevant Journal articles, prompts and products.

### **Gentle Journal Prompts for When You're Grieving**

A soft collection of prompts for people who are carrying loss and need a safe place to put their thoughts, memories, questions and emotions into words.

### **How Do I Start Over After a Breakup?**

A reflective guide for anyone trying to rebuild their sense of self, routine and hope after a relationship ends.

### **Why Do I Feel Guilty After Someone Dies?**

A compassionate exploration of grief-related guilt and the difficult questions people sometimes carry after losing someone they love.

### **Journal Prompts for When You Feel Lost**

Prompts designed to help you slow down, listen to yourself and begin understanding what you need next.

### **Journal Prompts for Starting Over**

Gentle questions for people entering a new chapter after disappointment, loss, change or uncertainty.

### **How Do I Know If I Am Healing?**

A reflective guide to the quieter signs of emotional healing that may be easy to miss.

### **Journal Prompts for Healing From Heartbreak**

Questions to help you process what happened without rushing yourself into pretending you are okay.

### **What Do I Do When I Miss Someone I Cannot Have Back?**

A compassionate reflection on longing, memory, acceptance and learning to carry love without remaining trapped in the past.

### **Journal Prompts for Self-Discovery**

Questions that help readers explore identity, values, fears, desires, boundaries and the person they are becoming.

### **What If I Don't Recognize Myself Anymore?**

A reflective resource for people who feel changed by grief, heartbreak, disappointment or a major life transition.

## **12. SHOP**

The Shop should be a dedicated, clean ecommerce area. It must be easy to browse, understand and purchase digital resources.

Each product page should contain: product name, clear description, who it is for, what is included, preview/mockup images where appropriate, price, secure checkout, delivery information, and a clear purchase button.

Initial product direction:

- 31-Day Gentle Healing Journal
- Journal prompt collections
- Easy how-to / practical guides
- E-books
- Reflection workbooks

Future expansion can include courses, audio resources, books and other educational materials.



## 13. SUBSTACK INTEGRATION

Substack remains a major part of the ecosystem.

- Every major article page should have a natural invitation to subscribe.
- Home page should include a prominent but tasteful Subscribe on Substack section.
- Use direct links to the official Substack publication and subscription page.
- Selected website content can point readers to the full Substack publication.
- Do not make every page feel like an advertisement for Substack; the website must provide standalone value.

Primary publication: The Healing and Growth Journal on Substack.

## 14. CONTACT PAGE

Keep the Contact page simple and professional. Include a contact form, relevant email/contact details when supplied, and a brief explanation of what visitors can contact the Journal about.

Do not make the page cluttered.

## 15. IMAGE & ART DIRECTION

Images are extremely important. The website should avoid generic stock photography wherever possible.

The image direction should communicate real human emotion, reflection, healing, quietness, hope and becoming.

- Soft natural light.
- Warm, muted, gentle colour palettes consistent with cream, light green and subtle orange.
- People in thoughtful, natural moments rather than exaggerated smiling or crying stock-photo poses.
- Quiet rooms, windows, pathways, nature, handwritten pages, journals, hands, silhouettes and intimate everyday moments can be used where relevant.
- Use diverse people and situations without making the site feel like a medical or corporate campaign.
- Images should leave emotional space around the subject and work well with text overlays when necessary.
- Use wide hero images for major sections and 1:1 or 4:5 images for cards and social previews.
- Every image must have meaningful alt text for accessibility and SEO.

## **15.1 Home hero image direction**

A quiet, emotionally resonant scene suggesting a person moving through a difficult but hopeful season. Avoid cliché images of someone dramatically crying. The feeling should be reflective, intimate and hopeful.

## **15.2 Healing imagery**

Natural light, solitary reflection, a person near a window, walking outdoors, hands holding a journal, quiet rooms, subtle signs of recovery and calm.

## **15.3 Growth imagery**

Open roads, paths, sunrise/sunset light, someone writing or reflecting, movement forward, plants/new growth, a person standing with quiet confidence.

## **15.4 Love / Sunday Love Series imagery**

Tender but sophisticated imagery: hands, letters, two people in natural connection, quiet intimacy, distance, memory and affection. Avoid overly romantic cliché stock photography.

## **15.5 Grief imagery**

Use restraint. Images should communicate absence, memory, quietness and love rather than dramatizing pain. Avoid funeral clichés wherever possible.

## **15.6 Product imagery**

Create clean digital mockups of journals, guides and workbooks. Use the brand palette and enough whitespace to make the products look premium and trustworthy.

# **16. RESPONSIVE DESIGN**

- The website must be designed mobile-first.
- All pages must work cleanly on mobile, tablet and desktop.
- Navigation must be simple on mobile.
- Text must remain highly readable.
- Buttons must be large enough for touch interaction.
- Images must be optimized for speed without visibly reducing quality.

# **17. TECHNICAL / SEO REQUIREMENTS**

- Fast loading speed and optimized images.
- HTTPS/SSL.
- Responsive design.
- Search-engine-friendly page titles and meta descriptions.
- Clean, human-readable URLs.
- XML sitemap.
- Robots.txt configured correctly.
- Canonical URLs where needed.
- Open Graph/social sharing metadata.
- Schema/structured data where appropriate, especially for articles, products and organization information.
- Google Search Console setup.
- Google Analytics or another privacy-conscious analytics solution.
- Accessible headings and semantic page structure.
- Alt text for meaningful images.
- Easy content management so new articles and products can be added without rebuilding the site.

## 18. WEBSITE FOOTER

The footer should contain:

- The Healing and Growth Journal logo/name.
- Short brand description.
- Navigation links.
- Substack link.
- Subscribe link.
- Social media links.
- Contact link.
- Privacy Policy.
- Terms and Conditions.
- Refund/return policy where applicable for products.
- Copyright information.

## 19. CALL-TO-ACTION JOURNEY

The website should guide visitors naturally through this journey:

READ → SUBSCRIBE → DOWNLOAD → BUY → EXPLORE → RETURN

A visitor should never feel trapped or pushed into buying. Every CTA should feel like a useful next step.

## 20. DESIGN PRINCIPLES — NON-NEGOTIABLE

- Do not make the website look like a generic wellness website.
- Do not overload it with stock photos.
- Do not use aggressive sales language.
- Do not make every section visually identical.
- Do not crowd the pages.
- Do not use too many colours.
- Do not make the website overly clinical.
- Do not make it look like a generic Substack template.
- Do preserve the warmth, vulnerability and emotional intelligence of the brand.
- Do create clear visual separation between sections.
- Do use whitespace generously.
- Do make the website easy for a first-time visitor to understand within seconds.
- Do make the site feel like a real editorial brand with a future beyond a blog.

## 21. FUTURE-READY STRUCTURE

The architecture should allow future additions without redesigning the whole website.

- Paid digital resources.
- 31-day journals and other guided journals.
- Courses.
- Personalized support / conversation offerings.
- Personalized schedule design.
- Books and publishing projects.
- Community initiatives.
- Future professional services.
- Potential Healing Institute / broader educational platform.

start here articles



substack Invitation





Tab 2

